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Weekly Policy Memo: Week of June 8, 2026

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The House Ways and Means Committee held a full-committee hearing on digital-asset taxation, advancing discussion drafts on de minimis relief, stablecoins, mining and staking rewards, routine network fees, and related parity provisions. DCG organized a DC Fly-in with a focus on financial privacy. The week also kept exchange and custody access for privacy assets in focus under EU AMLR and MiCA.

Key Takeaways

- The June 9 Ways and Means hearing was a discussion hearing, not a markup, so no legislation advanced out of committee.
- Seven tax discussion drafts covered de minimis transaction relief, stablecoin treatment, mining and staking rewards, routine network fees, securities lending, mark-to-market parity, and charitable-deduction parity.
- Written submissions for the hearing record are due June 23, 2026.
- The June 10 DCG Fly-in put financial privacy in crypto before congressional offices and connected that advocacy to the CLARITY Act debate.
- EU AMLR and MiCA continue to keep privacy-coin exchange and custody access in focus as implementation timelines approach.

Action Items

- Call your Senator and ask them to support the CLARITY Act with the Blockchain Regulatory Certainty Act provisions preserved.
- Share accurate corrections when EU or Philippines privacy-coin ban narratives circulate.
- Repost PGPZ X and LinkedIn posts to increase visibility and promote the Community.
- Educate your network about Zcash.
- Engage with PGPZ by flagging concerns and the impact of policy developments.

House Ways and Means Held its Hearing on Digital Asset Taxation

On June 9, 2026, the House Ways and Means Committee held a full-committee legislative hearing on digital-asset taxation, organized around seven discussion drafts. Because it was a discussion hearing rather than a markup or floor vote, no legislation was passed out of committee.

- De minimis relief for small transactions.
- Stablecoin tax treatment.
- Deferral of mining and staking rewards.
- A de minimis exception for routine network fees.
- Securities-lending parity.
- Mark-to-market parity.
- Charitable-deduction parity.

The record stays open for written submissions through June 23.

Why this matters for Zcash

De minimis relief and network-fee treatment would reduce the friction that currently makes spending Zcash a taxable event. The fact that a full committee took up these concepts in a formal hearing signals that tax legislation is advancing from concept toward drafting, though the pace and bipartisan scope remain unsettled.

DCG Fly-in Brought Financial Privacy Advocacy to Capitol Hill

On June 10, Paul Brigner participated in DCG's congressional briefing and fly-in on Capitol Hill focused on financial privacy in crypto. In a June 10 thread, he described briefing Congress with DCG and Aleo on the need for financial privacy, including voter polling on crypto's growing salience, financial privacy, and the CLARITY Act. DCG's public recap described the fly-in as convening DCG executives and 20+ blockchain founders for policy discussions on data privacy and digital asset regulation.

Why this matters for Zcash

Meetings like these are crucial to educate policymakers on Zcash can be compliance-capable financial infrastructure - including transparent transaction modes and selective-disclosure tools - rather than a regulatory risk.

Privacy-coin Exchange Access Stays in Focus under EU AMLR and MiCA

This week's market volatility renewed attention on the standing regulatory risk for privacy assets: exchange and custody access. Under the EU's Anti-Money Laundering Regulation, licensed crypto-asset service providers face custodial restrictions on privacy coins phasing in by 2027, and MiCA conditions the admission of assets with built-in anonymity on providers being able to identify holders and their transaction history.

Recent privacy-coin ban narratives show why precision matters. In an EU correction post, Brigner noted that the relevant EU rules restrict what regulated crypto service providers may offer when holders or transaction history cannot be identified; they do not ban the Zcash protocol, ZEC ownership, self-custody, peer-to-peer use, or transparent Zcash transactions. In a Philippines correction post, he similarly noted that reports point to a BSP listing/support rule for licensed VASPs, not a ban on ZEC, the protocol, self-custody, or peer-to-peer use, and that the memo reportedly does not name Zcash.

Whether banks, exchanges, and custodians will serve the asset often matters more in practice than any single classification question.